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recovery

Recovery Process

N. A. RECOVERY

That the program of Narcotics Anonimous works as an a aresting entity against the diease of addiction is true. This truth is manifested by thousands of drug addicts who are clean and sober today.

That the spirit of Narcotics anonimous will wrok for any one is also true. N.A. has helped thousands of drug addicts, ranging from heroin addicts, to those psycholically dependent on marijuana. It works for all types of people youths of 14 or 15 are recovering. School youths, lofers, senior citizens, house wifes, prostitutes, incarcerated folk, professional people, people in the service..... It works for all these.

Ther is no barrier to N.A. recovery except the failure to tell the truth, closed mindedness to the truth, and unwilliness to find the truth. These three are the are the dark places ~~xxxxx~~or refuges were lies creep in and haunt us. Narcotics Anonimous ~~the entity~~ dealswith the shattering of persoal deciet or soul sickness. It ends the lies. The primary lie for us is the one that would have us believe, that ther is no hope. The lie that would have us believing that our fate has been sealed. This lie is the "monkey on our backs". It tells us that inevitably life will never work with out dope, that dope is what holds our mind, body and soul together. N.A., the entity of the twelve steps, is available to help us to end these lies and ther tormenting ~~of us~~. A member of Narcotics Anonimous will tell you that his sincere desire for recovery, for something beyond the lie, for something better has lead to ~~has lead to~~ joy and freedom that he never suspected in his wildest dreams. Sincerely, he will tell you that with him the lie has been ousted by a power, a truth greater than " life for you will always be getting, using and finding ways and mean of getting more ".

This world is constantly changing. That we can survive in it clean and sober, even adapt to it and be a useful part of it is the very truth we drug addicts need to know. 14,000 drug addicts live this truth. It is reality for a drug addict in N.A. to become a warm, caring vital human being. This is not a false dream; it is the end of the lie that once sick there can be no lasting recovery. It has been happening every day for twenty seven years at this writing. Our 14,000 stories speak for them selves. We were all driven to the piont of complete, ~~unrecovered~~ defeat. When we surrendered the grace of God touched our lives. Today we seek to serve a God of our understanding ~~sugested~~ to stay clean and sober. WE live with varying degrees of comfort, peace, happiness and with joy in our lives. We live also in a freedom acording to how well we have been working twelve simple step for this day.

The more we talk to our ~~spners~~ SPONSORS, attend meetings, rely on God and simply dont put mind

#7 A.

#0166

altering or mood canging drugs in to our systems ,our diseased bodies.

The twelve steps

1. We admitted wewere powerless over our addictions that our lives had become ~~unmanigable.~~ UNMANAGABLE.
2. We came to believe that a power greater than ourselves could restore us to sanity.
3. We made a decision to turn our will and our life over to the care of God as we understood him.
4. We made a searching and fearless moral inventoy of ~~ourselves~~. OURSELVES
5. We admitted to God, to our selves and to another human being the exact nature of our wrongs.
6. We became entirely ready to have God remove our shortcomings.
7. We humbly asked him to remove our shortcomings.
8. We made a list of all persons we had harmed and become willing to makeamends t o them all.
9. Wemade direct amends to such people where ever possible except when to do so would tinjure them or thers.
10. Wecontinued to take personal in ventory and when we we wrong promptly admmitted it.
11. We sought through prayer and meditation to improve ouro consious contact with God as we understood ~~Him~~ HIM ; praying only for knowlege of his will for us an the power to carry that out.
12. Having had a spiritual awakening as a result of those steps,we tried to carry this message to addicts and to ppractice these principles in all our affairs.

Check against book OD

STEP 1. We admitted that we were powerless over our addiction x that our lives ~~have~~ had become unmanagable. This is step one, the truth we accept out of desperation . A man who will not accept this step in his inner most ~~conciesss~~ ESSENCE can not recieve help to subdue his addictive personality. It is in step 1 that the realization of utter powerlssness and utter lack of control over our habits and our behavior patternsxthatxx is made . This oddly enough allows us to move into a frame of mind conducive to clean and sober living on a daily basis.

Drug addiction is a progressive ,incurable, and terminal illness. A disease which destoys our self respect, our respect for life, for love, and God. Tragically, this is all true. The mind becomes diseased and will function in a bizzarre and obsessive manner; leaving the victim a subject of the insanity of constant preocupation with drugs and the way of life there of. The body too becomes the subject of the compulsive aspect of drug addiction. The body of the drug addict will become upset if not provided with drugs freely. The mind and body are bound together in this way they lose touch with reality ; craziness sets in. Deep within the addict his spiritstaved of truth, unable to express itself sleeps dormently leaving the mind and the body to them selfs. The spirit it is said has the functions of giving and recieving love, truth freedom, joy and all of the things which are real and lasting which can only be transmitted through the spirit.

7 — A.

#0166

(3)

After it has been cut off from the bodyand the mind they can know none of these. They would soon perish from emotional in stability,a broken heart so to speak.Loneliness then sets in for the kill ,After feling degrees of guilt, dispair, depression, angrer and fear, loneliness sets in. We are very suseptable to death at these times because it is when we are isolated that we take those fatal over doses. when no one is around and we feel like it we may kill ourselves. Some addicts do get locked upfor our own good but this is hardly any better than over dose, or being shot or killed some how. Often an addict will feel like telling some one to stpop the world and le t him off.

To sum it up: Sweating for drugs and from drugs
Dying for drugs and from drugs.
This is addiction.
Obsessed with drugs;posessed by drugs.
Compulsion for drugs and for more after tha
With three ends the jails are full of us
TThe institions teem with us
The cemetaries are full of us.Merciless in getting more drugs ,through addiction We aremercilessly maimed and crippled and killed.In N.A. addiction makes us brothers and sisters we recognized our addictive personalitoes while we still had some time left
None of us can say how long we had left but we can tell you that the way we were going we were all goners. That to be caught up in the grips of addictionto any drug or drugs is to be caught up in the grips of a distuctive, tricky power ,unpredictable and vastly out of our controll.So, intruth we are all powerless over our addiction in N.A. for addiction is incureable.Our lives are unmanagablefor we can not think of running them . We always need drugs if we as individuals are to cope with life on its own terms.Together we cope with life better. Before any group can meet ouer needs it would have to have a common gaol(ours is to stay clean and soder one day at atime and help others to do so) It would have to have members similar in dispsiton (we are all addicts and there for one of a kind) and it would have to really meeyt our needs(our fellowship at the time of this wwriting numbers 14,000 it can meet your needs for recovery too.)

Still our lives are unmanagable , we dont really want to die we just dont know how to live. What do we do? Surrender to a power greater than ourselfsand greater than our addiction. Remember that the real first step ,it is said, is "do you want what we have and are you willing to do what ever is nessesary to get it.If we use drugs we die. Back to this power greater than our selfs that it is not of thi s world is true. The world changes and imposes its demandson us ,the truth heals. We who have come to believe in something other than our matrial posessions,in a sourse of power greater than any on earth, posess the truth strong egnough to thwart The lie of addiction. There , after all has to be some explanation why 14,000 hope to die dope fiends are living happy , productive and drug free lives.

7-A,

These 14,000 can give acounts of how they personally came to believe in some sort of a higer power with and most wonderfully without religiuos authority interveining.

There are no must in N.A. we are free to understand God as we please.

Basically, to know the truth is to love it and be cared for by it this allieviates our having to run our own lives on self will. The truth does exsist , were as lies exsist only to those who believe them. It is a mere superstition than addict cant stay claen and get anew life. Wiehter or not we believe it the truth exsists and weither or not we want to belive it the truth is willing to help us. As long as we are merely willing to believe in a power greater than our selfs we will do well. this is where the opendmindedness comes to play. Intolerancee or indifference toward a higher truth or set of truths than we now understand will defeat us in our recovery. The 12 steps contain many spiritul truths and lessons so we might as well be opened minded and teachable and remember that contempt prior to investigatinn is a block to all knowlege.

We keep an opened mind remember we change... if we are willing to do so we can can our beliefs by opening our minds. We changed for the worst while using so why if we got sicker cant we also get better.Truth is power. It is greater than alieWhen we took up a belief in atruth of our understanding we put our beliefs and thoughts to agreater power than any lie. Reflecting on the truth,we dissolved the shackles that held our minds closed. Our minds opened at last to a new life. Step two suggests that wecame to believe in apower greater thanourself that can restore us to sanity. Looking up "restored"in the dictionary we see it defined as"made whole". Many of us had not ever felt whole before taking this step. We had always felt alack of something within ourselves.We felt inadiquate to live up to our potential or other peoples expectations of if or our own . We felt we had to have something to compensate and thougth we had foun g it in drugs.So to be restored to a drug addict may be inconcievable. It merely means to be completed.Through this ste p we come to believe in apower that can complete us as human beings.With our belief in this power we begin to move toward completeon.Some of us N.A. call this process growth or spiritual progress.

We had tried all other method and with failure They didnt work that is our experience. Our answer had to lie in the belief in a poer greater than ourselfs. Some of us callthis power God. As we cometo believe we continue to reflect on our higher power or God if you like. We do this lest we forget the truth and fall back the deceptivness of addiction. When we reflect on what we believe to be true we can feel our perspective and sanity return. At this point we can think straight many of us for the first time in our lives . W may pray to this power to restore us to sanity believing in its power and trusting its will.We may pray that it reveal itself to us. We find that belief is a bond of trust. Just as we would trust a car to make ajourney with we can trust God infinitly, according to our undrestanding of him.

7-A.

#0160

WHEN we remember to use God to help us he will never fail. The important thing seems to be trusting in a loving , fun sort of God with awilling spirit. It is our experience that we could not stop using drugs until we were ~~Ix~~ Lxxx lst beaten down by the drugs we were taking: 2nd that we be willing to try spirtual principles. The later adherence to spiritual principles gives us hope. Our experience shows that those who seek help from god have an easier , happier experience of life; almost an enhance ment process which returns us to the happy, and simple joy of being childlike even in the face of confusion. This is what experience ~~xxx~~ in being opened to the concept of a God who loves us has demonstrated to us over and over; day after day.

GOD CAN also be referred to as Good orderly direction, if you will. For sure this god cares egnough to help ;we wouldnt be here if not for Its help. Attributes of being ever present, all - kn owlegable and all powerful are certain universal of many major world beliefs. If you have been turned off to God by a certain sect remember alot of us were too, and that we woke up after hereing that it is God as we understand God From personal experience. That sect represents one point of veiw, there are infinite numbers of concepts to come to believe in. The idea of a vast universal power may not appeal to me so I will reflect on God as a friend in need, or as asilent friend.

With an opened mind may you find God as you understand God Now. Patience is avirtue most of us simply hung around, ~~x~~ didnt use and kept coming back because something was working and came to believe gradually in a God of our understanding. We found eventually that our new ideas of God replaced those old concepts and faith took on a new meanig. We felt it working in our lives and in the lives of our fellows.

Through the year of our insanity something had to be looking out after us, call that God. Contrary to many religious teachings we believe in an absolutly loveing God who gives us full permission to conceptualize him in any form and encourages it. This program as borrowed from God is of devine origin, a saving grace. Remember easy doe s it save your ass before you save ~~xxx~~ your soul. Its O K.

In N.A. we are not forsed into any belief or we will be kicked out we wouldnt survive long as a group if we did. We are free in N A to believe as we are able to and should never be fored to believe in any one s idea of God.

Alot of us come to believe by asking God to keep us clean and sober another day and thank him at night. Thus we aviod that one fix, pill , toke or drink too many. Also there is an energy at the meeting an X -factor some call this there higher power.

Alot of us are put off by the fact that the second step says "restored to sanity. Restored means mae whole. Remember that sanity has many definitions. It is more/less alegal term to be ruled insane and almost always against the person so labeled ~~s~~ will. In this case it was not a human jury but drugs that ruled us hands down insane. Why keep going back to fight such apowerful foe as drags?

#016-6

So to have this obsession for drugs and these physical compulsions pionts out insane behaverior. A definitoin of sanity to have the sincere desire to stop using drugs and be willing to go to any lenghts to do so seems sufficient for the moment. In truth the being shk off from Gods reason is insanity. There for with anopened mind we let gods reason replace our insanity. Remember how our best thinking got us in jails, institutions, and to the program. Our ways never worked for the better only for th e worse; although they seemed like the best possible couse at th e time thyey were really the products of incomplete thinking. To be restored to sanity then maens to be made complete. The second st ep is a life time press ess .

Each time the desire or cumpusion is opon us we may appeal to God over and over to restore our sanity. This our experiense shows is to the thinking through of the compulsion to the morning after or when it si gone or through to what happened last time. This accompanied by the clarity of mind phenomina of being again saved by the grace of God from our horrible would be fate. That this is our right and Gods will should be clear. Addiction is an insane way of life for anyone.

When we have a degree of trust in the God of our understanding this will bring us to step three. We made adisision to turn our will an our lives over to the Care of God as we understood him. The wiil covers the powerless part of step one and we begin to see alittle truth . we had been willful and powerless to have our will. Then the turnimg iof our lives over to thecare of God frees us from something that is really too big for us to handle, our unmanagablity. Weve never been self suffecint ;especially while using dope we were the most dependently resignated people alive and one might add the most miseable toward the end. So over to God go our will and life.

An addict who has this chioce wether to live by spiritual principles or face drug addiction is lucky, luckier than the 60 of us who die each hour from addintion. However forsome this is atough disicion. They may go back to the second step to stengthen thier belief in a loving God .

Many of us rebeled and wanted to keep some of oueselfs thank-you! Or we wanted to give ti all to God be done with it and take no more responsibility for it. Traditionally we are making adisison to let God Determine what our futrare a and present and simply follow that through thick and thin.

Rmmemdre we are not giving in to the tyrany of God but are surrenering with complete abandon to his compassion, loving guidence and care with complete abandon. We lret this God of our understabnding be our only ultimate authority, speaking thruogh other people and literature as well as direactly thruo gh prayer .

Remember in step 2 wwe developed a concept of a loving God one we could rely upon in our time of need., with complete trust. So we find that step 3 doesnt take the fun out of living ,the dope did that . Step 3 is an answer to our living problems and not sonme burden over head rather it is thruogh step 3 and others like it that we obtain real freedom from self bondage. As a matter of fact the need to trancend our selfishness is universal in all people

7-A.

we addicts found that thier was no way to trancend our selfs in our normal every day activities. Or we werent wliiing to so we used drugs to cop out it worked briefly and them we fell in to the hell of complete and total chemical dependency. Luckily for N.A.ers today thruogh a highrer power we can serve we can and do trancend our self will.

In step 3 we begin to make aconcious effort to comform to Gods will daily. That our willwas killing us and that it was no more than adeceptive death wish which takes us back time and time again toto thoughts of using , of dispair , dipression, anger, fear, self pity and lonly ness is our exprience When we use it selfishly with out good orderly directionour will is the opposite of freedom rather we are soon crying for another way. S o to turn our will and life over to the care of this God . What does it mean. It means we cant handle it any longer . It means we as addicts have to or our addiction will comsumes us. In reality we are giving it to the best friend we ever had. The real miricle is that we survived to arrive at a program that would give us relieif , another way . From afar God is frightenig but the closer you get to this devine being ,the more we realized that it had been our best freind all along. Our only real friend.

A dicrimitive willingness was the key which opened the door for us to the spirit that would give,genously to us new freedom and new happiness. A new life. Not a second go round at the old life but a new and different life. Blinded by our ad diction we used drugs as our seeing eye dog they lead us into ablind ally. Even they had ripped us off. We still long to see. Until we do we now have anew guide. This one we checked out in step 2 , it is the God of our understanding we have turned it over too: the whole show is now in his hands.

We unquestioningly followed our grim wills now we strive to follow Gods will. Accepting guidence in this way Gods will takes over when and only when we have abandoned our own. "Thy wlii not mine be done" takes the place of "what do I do now". Our unmanagable lives were the product of using drugs and being addicts with a living problem. When we live inthe disease we live in the problem. Upon acepting spiritual principles we live in the solution to whatever problems we may have in our lifes.

(Principles ,historically are things that always seem to work. A spiritual principle is an ad to solving problems that might come up. Because tey work, they are pasted from generation to generation as things to do in case of emergency that will always work if applied.)

We have experienced a loving, benign, caretaker in God , an a feeling of protection and safty so long as we do the foot work and do not use drugs and sabotage our recovery process. When indoubt we can fall back on step 2 untill we have sufficient belief in a loving God to go on to step 3. For this God of our own understanding is our out and only through such as that can we be free.

7-A

0166

(8)

Self medication is the essense of drug addiction there fore self will is the cause of our pain and miserability our plain old addiction. Through healthy dependence on God and service to to God as we imagine him to be like is we pass into a new life with the knowlege that god will take charge. We find invariably he does a better job at plannig than do we.

If we are not willing to make such astep we may ask for the willingness to beready., to take this step. It is not nessecery to take step # alone . We may take this step in any way in witch it suits us and can be most real and meaningful to each of us. God must be experiened in all things if he rum ns the univrseso he is apt to straightn out any area of our life theat we may find amiss provided we sincerely ask. If it doesnt change or get better we figure that its soppsed to be that way and that the out come will simply be better than our wildest dreams. Some may call this niave ,pesonally I callit proper use of the will; remember our best ideas got us here.

In cases of the above a principle like acceptance can provide in sight . We have a formula availiabe .We make use of it. It is the serenity prayer.:

God grant me the surenity to acept the tings I can not change. The courage to change the things I can and the wisdom (or honesty) to know the difference.

We make use of this. Accetance is an art worth learning. Remember God can be niether seen nor sensed except throught re fective imagination,on him.That we are only doing foot work. is our only concern. God can and will handle the big stuff as long as we take ourselfs out of the picture and seek to take an intesest in being of selfless service to others .

OUR self centered existence be fore coming to NA was killing us to recover we ought to put time and energy into helping others. This way ,although on a seemingly powerless and un managable level we can help ourself out of a jam thruogh taking time out to be of help to some one who could die because we were worried about our fovorite topic ,ourselfs instead of reaching out to others. These steps are our bread and butter they give us the grace to help another addict who if we didnt help would die of our disease. When we can feel God working through us to help another our problems go and peace comes. Then we know we have made agood start on step 3 . Weare to work it more indept but are now at step 4.

Step 4 reads that we made asearching and fearless moral inventory of our selfs . So we addicts find that we still have short comings . Its no wonder as sick as we were We still have alot of recovery ahead of us . The 4rth step is like taking stock in ourselfs as abussineess enterprize . We are enterprising to carry the message to the addict who but for the Grace of God working through us w would die. Our defects of charactor are what allows us the chance to rellapse , be very unhappy and to die.

7-A,

0166

9

Self centered ness or ego centricy , the inabitliy to see out side of ourselfs is something that will defeat us unless an attemp to be of help to others with out the thought of our selfish, outside of just staying clean and soder. Our enterprise in life is to carry our experience, strenght and hope to the suffering addict where ever, and however we can to whoever we can so that they wont have to die, and so we can keep what we have. If we are concerned only with "what do I want to do next " we will be miserable . Our recovery is contingent on selfless service daily. So with adesire to be of better sevice to others we launch into this inventory, having given God our will and our live we proceed to explore that which caused us so much hurt for so long and that which made possible the saving grace of god to enter our lives. So in our present we can gain more freedom from our obsessiom with me. Remember self centeredness is a subtle foe it can slip into our lifes so quietly and suddenly that we are aware of it only after it is been removed.

God does this inventory thruoghus a subjective full acount of our past . The wreckage of which when traced down to the culpert is always we find us, our own selfcentered thoughts and actions. We should make aprayer that God, as we understand him , keep our attention on good we could have done others and on striveing on lines of progress.

Under no circumstanse are we beyond help for the Grace of god is far reachimg and ever ready to lovingly respond to our crys for help. Any doudt of this is simply an error in couculations on our part xxxx alie if you wish. Our miscalculation got us here and that is why we turned our will over to the care of God . Head hassles may creep in and complecate what is really going on and we then stop and look around " do I have food in my belly, Clhths on my back, a place to sleep, clean and sobers?" Good! This isnt too bad . how about that poor slob thats going to die because Im worring about me. How can I be afriend to them how can I love the unloveable/?

By getting rid of the things that make it difficult to love and care and "sacrifice our money time and energy. We clean house to be rid of our defect because today we have achoice and aresponsibility., to uurselfs and others.

What are these defects? Pride lust greed anger envy coventousness vainity crulity self rightious ander selfishness and self centered ness , thier root, to name afew They can cause us pain and insanity even relapse if we hang on to themxxxxxxxx .

What are our moral friends prayer, honesty and selfless service to others. The great men of history are poeplre who loved and cared about others with thier primary objective to fill aneed in thier power to fulfill. This selflessness is an attribute of many dividends , happiness , peace, and love. It is the ground xx workxxxxx that will set us free

7-A.

10

The prosess involves courage, self controll , and effort on our part. Step 4 reads "we made asearching and fearless moral inventory of ourselfs " . Behind every steep there is aspiritual principle; step 4's is courage. After all what have we been runnig from all these years but our own self centered fears. Courage to change the things we can means us ,with Gods help ,for we are to find out that 2" if I am not the problem thier is no solution" ; that we are powerless over Gods will and to make these deeper admissions of wrongs in our make up inorder to set about correcting them requires couarage on our part.

Defects are in reality not at all our friends, it takes courage to see that it is thay that cause the misery and unhappiness in our lives. In a society where sense gratifcatio n was promoted we were like pleasure seeking amebas seeking to bask in glory , pleasure , and fullfill our desires in order to be free of them. The softer -easrier way is for us however to be rid of the desires than to comstantly be thier slave. Such wrong desires are our defects of c charactor, they have caused us problems such as drug addiction over wieghtness, lazziness, apathy , (toward ,every thing but our own pleasure.) on and on... What is the use of satisfying things that cant be satisfied.

The first step to removeing these thorns in our sides is to list them on paper. The drug addict sits down with paper and pen and prays for god to help him in this and and reveal the defects that are causing pian and suffering to himself and those virtues that have lent happiness and given peasce to himself. So that he can write them on paper taking stock in hisself that he can see what they are , how they do thier destructive work in his life and how the virtuesness has gotten him out of tight places hes backed into. We pray for the courage to be fearless and throrough that this inventory may help us to get our lifes in order so we can better help others. When we pray and take action it almost invariably goes well for us.

We may start by examineing indepht our relationsips to others people. places and things over the years. Listing our faults wre the relationship went down hill, cold, or resentful. We listed peole with whom we had resentful conflicts. Taking painful instances in our lives that caused us to get loaded or retaliate against others or our selfs and tracing them down to the decptive defeact responsible. For example ,we list all resentments we remember having on paper ; listing first the resentment then the <u>reason</u> we became angry in the first place. We discover the root of our angrer and find usually that we felt threatened in some way . Our dope supply was threatened, our drivers licenese was at stake, our position at work, our self image, our finances , sex life, were threatened. Anger ia just a smoke scrern for the fire of fearfulness.

The keys to this srep are courage and honesty

7-A

11

with out these there can be no truth, or self honesty. With out rigouer ous self honesty we are subject to living at the mercy of merciless lyes , and thats abig part of why we had to hurt so much before we saw that dishonest just doesnt work, it just renders us ignorant and miserably unhappy.

We must have aprofound personallity change ifwe are to stay clean and sober. An addict may angerilly deny his wrong inspite of all the evidence to the contrary. This is the familliar reaction to many of us the courage to move toward a new and unfamilliar response in order to let people really know us is the key for us to the succsessful forming of new relationships with God , ourselfs and other huma n beings.

Pride _ gossip - self righteous anger

Do I critizise harmfully? Do I stand up for people when they are not around to defend themselves ? Do I say the truth be hind the backs of others when it can be harmful or fatal to them? for my own sick pleasure/ Am I descrete about who I talk about to whom/ in what I say ?Do I say positive things to others holding back negative truths? Do I do unto others as I would have others do unto me?

Greed

How I behave when I see something I want? How I behave when I "am not getting wat I deserve? When I stand to lose something Ive become attaced to?

An addict may put on paper, for example, on his greediness " It was the greedy desire that kept me from happiness; ant not the failure to attain it. Isee now my greed isnt satiable, and its caused me alot of problems. For instance..."

OR

It was my greed which was the cause of that relationship failing. " Greed is counter balanced by charitable giving. We included our selflessness and wrote on that for example "... and just becauce of aliitle selfless ness and actual caring the project suceeded."

About our resentments we adictes can really be resent ful when something hurts our idea of us , a view we hold, something we love, or anything we may feel is important to us. Resentments are usually fairly deep seated wo unds to us. They can really cause us pain and misery. Who wants it? "well thats easy for you to say Me , Im mad at so andso and its not just going to go away" some one might say to us in a meeting.

Unfortunatly we are the victums of our resntments am thier for we should try cautiously to see where other people are correct. This opened minded look at the resntment lets God in to another area of our lives he can help now.

Because the resentment is most injurous to the holder of it our inventory should exclude the person , group, or institution or law that we be grdge. Its our inventory to help us ;that other person ,we can do nothing about.

7-A.

12

#0166

Thus having a description of why we are mad we immediately for get about the fact that we are not looking at other wrongs to us . That would be the old self ce ntered way we want a better way. Our disease is smart but if we look only at were we behaved undesireable then we have a chance of being teachable to, the truths that make life worth while for us and people we will meet in the future.

So we just look at our self s and write all this down. We just look at the harm we wrecked . Its our moral in vertiry. We pray and let God do it by way of us. Gods a True freind. W e find God can help us with our resentmensts We can let go and let God have them . or we can say a prayer for the person we are resentful at to have wonderfull good fortune , happiness, allthe things we would ever want for our selfs. In this way we follow a spiritual principle known as "The Golden Rule ", "Karma " and/or Brotherly love and in this way the resntment becomes the equipment by which we develop what is called emotional musle. We stay in the sun light of the higher power and stay clean.

Lust

Lust a sin? lust is something that we can put energy into and not even get any thing in return we think that we are getting something were not.

When in my past was I lust ful ?
When Was I a desent human being?
When was I a beast?
How often do I find myself thinking about sex?
Can I say No when I dont want to? (when to and when not to have sex is contigent on when and when it would be loving and best)
Am I willing to work toward sex Ideals?
What are my future sex ideals?

A prayer for gOd Tp shape our sex Ideal and to help us tplive up to the m is for many of us very desirabl e. Our heads are out to get us some times it is not thier faul t they are sick. They do however tell us things that are not true . A lie that the defects would have us believe is tha t we are terrible people and that God has turned down on us. See , the de fects want to run the show on self will if were running around doing Gods will they have to surrender. They are like instincts that we once got the desired results from and that now no longer give us results.

We just remember that doing what our head told us to is what got us sick.: not to let what our head tells us influence us in our dision making. Weve made our dision in step #3 . Now were along for the jouney . The head isnt runnig the show any more, but you try to tell it that . It doesnt work in reality in reality we depend on God. We depend on God for our , food , air, water, shelter , our li fe, is really in Gods hands. Try taking your next heart beat all by your self.

Envy

How envios am I ?
Am I happy to see my fellows doing well.
Am I evvious of others growth ,accomplishments or rewards?
Do I com pare my Insides to other people out sides?

7-A.

(13)

0166

It is through our distinghuishing inability to accept pessonal resbonsiblity for our mistakes that we actually create our own problems.

By blaming other persons for our fears and frustration s we do our selfs a greivious wrong. We never find out the real cuase is us and never seek a real solution. We simply get angry. If we continue to play these games clean and sober we dont stay that way. Resentments have a way of killing drug addicts in recovery. They stem from fear and that stems from ego centricity.

The game of blame is to us an irrevelent thing. That is not ourconcern inthis step , as far as we are concerne d the disease is the culpret. We should see this and take vigous action to have these defects removed. Some of us just have bad tempers and its apart of our disease. The NA program is not telling us to be adoor mat ,but it is a way to frreedom and peace of mind and as we go on we will learn to take up for ourselfs. For now we are cleaning up past wreakage we left in our wake by inventoring it.

If we are not the root of our troubles then the steps cant help us much. This is ahumbling admission but with it comes the feeling that the steps are the solution for us. For people who lived so long with out asolutio n this is a comfort indeed , more it is can make us useful and happy beyond our wildest dreams.

In truth the chioce of wiether to live inthe problem or in the solution has been ours all along. It was given to us by God ,however obscured by addiction it is still ours. We made a disision to live in the solution rather than the lie when we became willing to goe to any lengths to stay clean and sober as the people in the program of Narcotics anonimous. This chioce today is yours if you are readiding this page you dont have to go it alone and you never have to take drug ever again cotiogent on you sincere disire to not us e a drug today. Thats all. Its now apparent to us that if we use we lose ,we stay clean we win.

All resentments are to beplaced on paper anddescribed maybe even in catagories for example::::

Who ------- why --------- how .... was I affected (what ae area of my life was endanered as I saw It)

Elivia Coffmen	She really made me feel like a dork	Hurt my self image (fear that w/o her aproval ...)
Ernie Duffie	Liad me off my job . Ineeded that jod . Never told me why either.	Hurt my self suffic ieny and security Fear Im noboby anddX Ill not have egnough
Jimmy Sanders	Never paid for the bike He broke. Got the girl I wanted . And made gossip about me.	Self esteem hurt . blow to love life and man hood in questi on.

7-A.

-14-

Do I envy anothers place in soctity?Tthier sex life? Thier security? Intelliingence ? Physical prowness? looks ? ... ? ...?

ANGER

How short a fuse do I have?
When Is It shortest? At work ? driving ? hurring at any thing ?

Have I accepted my powerlessness and unmanagability over all people, places and things?

Do I try to Practice opened mindedness and tolerance toward all ?

XXXXX Do I think through my angry behaior ?

Can I grow spiritually when enraged?

Do I try to get made once a day because Imm hooked on my adernealene? Is it worth the high?

(anger and fear are very closely related , anger is caused by a faering burst of adrenalene , secreted by worring about my, by the adreneal glands.)

Anger can kill us and it is one of the most dangerous states of mind an addict can sustain. To hold on to a smoldering resentment is a sure ticket back to the insanity of using drugs. We addicts cant afford angers price tag , basically our lives. Do we get off on anger could we be addicted to it? Under its influecne we are subject to going right back to the way we felt during active addiction without using. This is called a Dry high, And it is the living of an angery life.

We just remember that every ones sick. For all we know this earth could be just a huge hospital for Gods children. We dont go up to someone who's dizzy from starvation, hunger , heat exastion or piosening and get angery, and say "shape up you" . But, thats exactly how silly angers effect is on others it may, however, seem important to us.

Remember we are sick human beings and we all hurt and when we hurt, we act badly. We get better from love and Grace, faith, compassion and trust. We shouldnt get mad at us or anyone we should pray for them till we can really mean it approx. two weeks.

Seeking to understand more the truth of what has come down ...than to try to be understood is the path to light and of couse forgivness. Drug addicts can be exeedingly difficult people. We are all beautiful in our own way ,many of us in the same way. Exceeding also is our sickness for witch we are not responsible. What ever living problems arise ,even like mountains we know there is nothing greater ,wierder, or more profound than the discovery of a high er power. A conquering force beneath all surface goings on. From that we draw the incredible strengh to surrmount and accept all obsticals, known and unknown. Bravery, in step four, let us not over look the obivous virtues those things about us that were so long even detested that somehow caused us to rise above what problems were on us. Even if they were squeezed out of us by grivious conditions when we had no choice but to die, we should list thes e virtues in us that would not die. That part of us that wouldnt die and all ways got us out of our jams.

7-A.

#466

-15-

Presicly how we lable virtue doesn't matter they could be "that feeling I got when I admmitted I was an addict" and "That time I just had to tell the truth" or "when I ,or something in me wouldnt give in to the insanity,because deep down it knew better" This by far is the most important aspect of recovery that we may know . Virtue is "for us a subordination of our actions and passions to ahigher will.Virtue is any action we take in accordance with our highest convictions. It is not nessesarily in accordance with any church doctrines.Virtue need not conform to to the things drummed into our heads during child hood though it may.And virtue is not a result of believing or accociating with the virtueous, it simply comsists in the doing, in the action." -Shekly Mitchell Day by day book. Virtueuos acts of kindness,politeness, charity,selflessness;the little forgotten good deeds. Inspite of all that is "wrong" with Us The fact that we do these loving acts shows that there are deep virtues in us that only need uncovering. We dont sell our selfs short. Gratitude,purity,honesty,sincere disire to stay clean and sober,compassion,sacrifice for others of time ,money or energy. Any act along lines of helping others we count as virtues. We put them down on paper remember we want the whole picture not some totally morose inventory. We find that if we are honest then our inventory will have as many positve things as negative. Suprisingly many of us had to pray for the courage to write the truth about our good qualities.

the higher self.

We are after all people with a deasease that touches our innermost soul. We are not moral leopores .Rememb er that type of thinking is atributed to our sick egos just getting down on theselfs out of brodom. We are sick ,yes. Bad ,NO!. We are people with a problem this is a deadly one we are merely trying to honestly appraise for porposes of recieving more help from He who has all power so we can help our selfs by better doing his will, because ours didnt work.

stinking

a problem

Other virtues include Fait h in a God with works leads tofullfillment,happiness ,joy and freedom. Independence through the dependence on aloveing power greater than our numbers combined . We strive for progress , for spiritual growth , not to be perfect or grow to the point where furhter growth is not possible. In other words It is ok to be where, who , you are; to be that right now.

and

This is the general feed back we got when we shared this information about ourselfs in step 5. Proceeding to step 5 .wefindthat after taking afearless and throuogh moral inventory that somehow wedont feelquiteright about it.We need to sit down with some one we can trust, who believes in our recovery and share with them every part of our fourth step. We dont keep any thing from them. We simplyshare frankly with point blank honesty every part of our honesty good and bad.

This might be hard for some .Not haveing opened up like this in years ior in a life time. However we are bound to get relief from shareing the deep dark seacrets that we never thought wed be sharing wyth any body. When we leave the company of the other person we should feel cleansed

out , like we have no untold seacrets.

Step 5 suggests that we admit to God to our selfs and to another human beingthe exact nature of our wrongs The principle behind step 5 is integrety. With honor and upprightеousness we should uphold the truth about ourselfs to another human being. Step 5 should include all of our various motives that we had for doing the wrongs we did. It is not to be taken lightly or half heartedly but with the greatest integrety we can muster as a preventitive measure against relapase. Remember that our lives are on the line. The vital improtance of this leap into an honest, opened and confidentially conducted shareing. This is when many of us make the deep gut level discovery that we are humman. With another human being, God and ourselfs we set the record straight.

When we do this Some times the pain of our disease is lifted from us. If we had been feeling cut off and probably the culprit, was us then we find areal peace and ease around others. We feel closer to God, To others and like a real human being. This is why, in NA, many of us say "it gets realer as well as getting better." A symonym of integrety is oneness with self and we fee;l this onenss flowing as a kinder more understanding out look on other peoples needs. We can also feel a oneness with out god and our fellow NAs that empathy so many of us will die without feeling. The main point is that we share with an integrity, that we confide in God ourselves and another human being the exact nature of our wrongs, and the truth they put on our lifes.

Thier are those of us who , having worked the fourth step will want to table this information* about ourselfs. They will feel that in telling it to another person that they would be deeply ashamed, however , we find that when putting our cleanliness on the line,,,, this is a reservation we should at all costs overcome. If we are embarrased fine, it will keep us humble.

* That only we know

Grave unfortunates who feel thay can not take this step or need not take it any time soon after completion of step four are living on a dangerous premise. We addicts may still have strong defects of charactor ailling us and disguised anger in "funky " behavior, being very superficial when at deeper levels we are really hurting. This is what we are so good at but it didnt work before and it will , experience shows, perevent us from sound and sane functioning of the mind, and reason. It inadvertantly leads back to our particular brand of self destructive behavior.

So personal integretly, so desperately needed by the drug addict, is indespenseable through out this vital step.

If we do not deal with these feelings our disease can and does , of course take hold of us. We may find ourselfs moving into slippery areas . For example, we many again seek out the old crowd, find enmployment in dubious places. This deases is a suble enemy and one we can take no chances with

If we do not have the personal integrity to deal honestly with outr thoughts , feelings and actions and thier underlying motives then we should certainly pray it be granted .

7-A.

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-17-

(17)

Each step taken should be acompanied by a period of prayer and meditaion ~~anyway~~.

Living a lye was what our addictions had foced us to. Its just the way we addicts are .For example ,in hospitals we ~~x~~ could neither be helped by the Pshciatrists ~~nor~~ be honest with th them about our prolems or our needs. We had not given the the courtisy of opened sharig ,though many of us tried hard. We still ~~M~~ felt reluctant to set our cards on the table ~~xx~~ ~~xx~~ and give ourselves a break. Our half truths baffled ourslves and the good ~~x~~ doctor. Therefore, Step ~~5~~ and the integrity it makes possible ~~It~~ gives us the break we need. Upon coming to NA we had to make such a surrender or die. The 5th step is as simple as that.

Step 6 becoming entirly ready to have God remove all these defect of characrtor. God really has removed alot of our more glaring defects ,most gracefully and mercifully too. ~~x~~ When we are taking step six it is important to remember that we are too human and should not place great expectations ~~x~~ on our selves.We should, however, remember that we are not → krep in mind kidding when we say entirly readyto have all these defect removed. This is a step of willines and either we are willing or we are not. That is the spiritual principle aof step ~~three~~ six ,willingness. It is as if t o say that we are now willing to move along spiritual lines toward a destination we can not imagion ,and strive to live life free from all our defects of charactor. Being human we will of couse fall short. ~~xx~~ ~~WE~~ will still get mads from time to time,especially if we are too hungery, lonely or tired. We will still feel our Lust , self pity , wrath, envy , pride, vainity, ~~x~~ crulty, greed, selfishness and ego centricity comming back prerhaps in differnt and new forms. We may feel dishonesty creep in and tell us that these new forms are all right ,that we may hold on willfully to them. The six step and or experiense show us that this form of self deseptoin ion only suceedes in covering our real motives which invariably are that we are trying to get what we want our of our lives. That we are still trying to manage our unmanagable lives and run the show,and take our will back from God's grace.

SOMETIMES only a constanot vigilance,which is the reapeating repetion of a short prayer over and over will be effective in changing our purposes in life. Pray untill our lives becomes a prayer . We may also say a prayer of this nature "God,I pray for the willingness to have you remove my every defect of charactor." Inreality we become willing instep 6 to let go of our defects , known and unknown. The petty desires that keep us chained to being stuck pleasure seeking ~~x~~ patterns which sooner or later lead us to sorrow or ruin. It is useful to ~~use to~~ visualize life with out defecta of charactor .We will want to know when a defect of charactor has crept in and to be ablie to identify it .This takes practice and vigilance.The trick is to become aware that d ef ects are the inconsistancies in our lives that kept us from reaching any goal worth while in life.They are also identified as parts of our addictive peraonalities that are the under lying cause of our relapes.One could say that the defects where the deep seated cause of anillness that using exsessive amounts of drugs obsessivly and complsively was a symtom of.So thn charactor defects are as much a part of our illness as the dope.

7-A.

WILLINGNESS is what we should strive for instep 6 the tools we use to make our willingness keen are prayer ,and practice and another is the prorities . How sincerly we will beable to work atep six will all so be preportional to our desire to cange. We often will feel that we will never be ready to have all our defacet removed but we ought to remember that the main point is that we are on a journy and that the destination isnt what matters,. what matters is that we are in a state of stiving to better ourselfs so that we may better serve God and our fellows. For we are doomed if we dont stive for a better way and try surrendering ~~lifted up when we surrender~~ to the simple instuctions that the program offers us as away to a new way of life.

Without defects life is ever new sensational and deeply wonderful. We can earnestly urge that we know that we are growing when we make new mistakes rather than the on the same old stituations cropping up again and again.

Life with the defects may cause perpetual frustration to us, we may relapse , we will at anyrate be in for an uncomfortable time of bearly getting by and dry runs frquently, haunting us.

WE sugest that we decide where our prorities lye , that we envision life free from the defects, and that we at the very least recogniz when our life is going sour that it is because of our defects and that it isnt the person place, or thing that is the cause of our problem. It is our defects. WE should at least accept personal responsibility for our problems.

Step seven suggests that "we humbly ask that He (God) remove these sort comings" The same God, that made short work of our compusion and obseesion to use, can and will remove from us our every defect of charactor if we are willing to turn them lose. This propositon is similar to the one when we asked that God restore us to sanity. when we were so hopelessly in the grip of insanity. We didnt know that we were insane until we took step one. We cant be aware of our defects and of the pain they are the cause of until we have worked to the best of our ability on Steps 4,5,6. If we have worked well these steps then we can see ,and can help but see that our charactor defects are not secretive ,"cute" little elements that we possess. On the contrary it should now be clear that "our " defects of charactor are in charge, making our lives unmanagable, making us undoly upset or irrationally afriad. They cut us off from God , from reality , from honesty. They are like broken records in our minds. They are the parts of us that are defective. ~~ive~~. They no longer work .We no longer need them. They interupt other wise beautiful times in our lives. We can no longer hack it with those defects always around.

We are now willing to do something about them . We should now want to be rid of them. We've been brought to the point were we want something better. Our sincere desire to grow to change implies wisdom to know the difference. We should now with faith act on this wisdom.

We pray To God saying something to the effect of "God, I pray that I may submit my defective personallity to your (thy) virtuos will ,that I may better serve others. That I may be a more perfect instument of your

7-A.

-19-

will ,I now humbly ask that all my defects of charactor be removed. Amen"

In the english language the word humble takes on so many definitions and many of them are demeaning. The spiritual principle of step 7 is humility,. Humility to us means that we have emtied ourselves of all desire to exersise prersonal selfwill,to have shunned all preconcieved opinions in the serch to be whole hearted in the serch for God. "

Remember thar the real purpose of this is to bring us into harmony of God and therfore to better be of help to him and our fellows. This is our primary reson for working all the steps. To be of true help to other peole who hurt and are phelpless to help them selfs just as we are even now. WE need to help others if we are to help our selfs . This is especially true of us addicts it is written "Give it away to keep it." We give to live, and We live to give.

The principle behind step 8 is brotherly love. Weve hurt and weve been hurt . All of us have stepped on others ,feelings, finances and futures to secure our drugs. We hurt alot of people, most of all we hurt our selves. Step 8 reads" "We made a list of all persons we had harmed and became willing to make amends to them all."

We harmed ourselfs the most we must be willing at least to made amends for the harm that we have done ourselves. Brotherly love is the love for our fellows, if weve been thouro gh we will feel selfish love evaporating as it does step eight becomes an adventure a dream come true, somrething nice that we can do. To be sincerely willing to "make amends with people weve harmed is may be hard for us. "wait aminute we say the other steps had to do with me...this amends means Ill be working with other people... I'm scared"

Well, we know also that we have an ideal here, it is brotherly love. We dont go to our old connections and tell them of the tomes we short changed them. They are to likly to misundrer stand . They wont here our words , they will want to kill us . To them we are clean and may be a Narcotics agent, or, they will feel we have wronged the egnough gh to justify murder. Remember we valued our dope highly.

We stay clear of these old play mates.

We feel that brotherly love is a tool of the NA program that helps ous survive . The old indifference toward others didnt allow us to feel for any one. It had ceased working. WE had to see that looking out for number one all those years ripping every one else off was a product of our defects and nessesary for survival on the street. Now we dont have to lie steal cheat and con. The ones who showed us love to whom in return we showed hate, dishonesty,or harmed; our familly , bosses, teachers, stores we stole from, every one we harmed living and dead we writer our list. WE should go back to our fourth step as a reference. (do to the spiritual nature of NA we may work the 8th step on the deceased ,"we need only be willing " when the time comes we leave the amends up to God,being as the nature of our illness demands our utter dependence on God. For now ,and now is all we have, we are willing beyond ashadow of adoubt to make the indicated amends.

7-A.

Willing to go to any lenghts to achive a spiritual awakening we go over our list. Step 9 -"We made direct amends to all such people, except when to do so would injure them or others." We ,remembered that the others included us, with in the relm of tact, common sense , consideration for others who may be affected in any way adversly by our amends making ., we balked at nothing. For the amends we least wanted to make were the ones that we stood to lose from. ourselves. We use our own discersion on this highly personalized mission . We must not faulter. We need to press on . We know that the spirit is with us that we have the spirites of thousands of addicts with us as we work this step. Our heads may tell us strange things . Our best ideas got us here. WE ,put the "I" out of it. "God and I " Make the amends together.

" Disipline for us means doing the foot work of God. "God thy will be done in me and through me". We addicts have always been long on talk and short on action. We know the instructions;now we act in acordance with our clearest conciuocnence . In this step we set in to acion the willingness and brotherly love of step 8. Now we have a plan of action ;we follow through wuith it. "

We always dicuss an amend with our sponser or some other person knowlegable about what and why wer are about to do what we are about to do.

The reason we do it is because if we dont we will die. An interesting concept of tact is when we are speaking with our crediters we bring up that we will use again if he doesnt make a deal where we can remberse him /her and that he then will not get his money any way, well be dead. Even the most rapios creditor will see the logic in this We have let him know why we have approached him. Dead or in jail we can't pay him, clean and sober we can.

We dont approach anyone that weve harmed with an attitude and a speech of how God has saved us"aleluia.. and now Im all different" He will not take us seriosly and will not see any sincerity.

So we approach him humbly, with a sincere desire to right a wrong,with full knowlege of what we are doing and a will to make amends. Our words can be used against us but our sincerity and actions will speak for them selves. We are trying to clear up all we can of our past, God is with us , our real purpose is to fit ourselves to be of service to God and our fellowes. We are getting the self out of it. So that our selfish desires may become sincere desires ,that God may find us worthy to be used as an instrument . There is a peace and serenity that comes about from working this step. We live this step, Amends may take years of people watching us change but the peace and comfirt of having a real purpose in life and a good motive are positively wonderful.

This is true . We dont need a lot of lies . We can make it and be happy following the road map of the twelve steps. We are truly lucky people. Our recovery is a way of life we never thought to be possible. Many of us never dreamed a way like this could even exist. We are growing but the suffering addict may die but for our being there,. We make amends and

giving them up.

conscience

1-make the amend

P-New Paragraph →

* living the truth

7A.

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0166

Would do well to practice our gratitude now.

Step 10

ACTUALLY, THE 12 steps are our freedom and our hope. They set us free we are lucky to have such a reliable method of understanding our selves as step 10 . Step 10 "the continuing of moral inventory and when we wre wrong we prompty admitted it". Of couse we promptly addmit it. When we do we obtain immediate release from the fact that we were not right. We dont have to live with guilt. We dont have to live in dread of being found out. Resentment cannot steal our freinds and such closness to our frinds can result, as will give ego release New freinds can and do result. Of courrse we are setting our house in order ,its OK to be wrong so why not own up to it whemn we are. we make our own corrections.

Angriness , self pity and selfishness should be put down we dont need to pay that price today ;there exists another way. egocentric

We addmit our wrong to God, who made us, a friend to whom we have had suffer at the errors of our human fallibility, and to ourselfves who we have decived to not allowing ourselves the right to be wrong. We addicts try to keep in mind and in heart that we are as imperfect prone to be sick the sick can suffer . Also, to another person if we wish to be Free.

The spiritual principle behind step 10 is preserverence . It does take great perserverece to work this wonderful step .The benifits,however, can not be measured. This is our precious experience.

Two types of inventories and probably more exist. One is the check list . Like it's other perferred form the sex, securty, society inventory, it will save our lives. A word of caution best put is to say that we are never through with the steps,in that we can not say (and be honest) that it is ok to coast . Coasting is what precedes a relapes. Coasting is a form of sloth , complacence. To be constantly working step 10 is nessesarry when we are not devoting time and energy to helping others. So, the 10th step is ameans to better help our fellows if we benifit from it fine. If not (and this is unusual) then we procede to the other steps,11 and 12 . we do not wallow, it makes us useless to wallow.

but makes a more beneficial service to others.

We find that the threads that our recoveres hang on are honesty(step 10) , prayer and meditation(step 11) and selfless service (step 12). When we say that there is no end or interlude in working the steps we mean that there needs to be abalance. If we are just honest then we are bound to get caught in the bough of self centered fear. If we are just prayerful we are bound to lay about waiting and not doing. If we are just into selfless service then we will be come selfish servants. If we are selfish servants then we can become over possesive , manipulative, resentful. WE then would go back to honesty. The point is we strive for balance. We always could try our best and since we were with out a balanece we fell. Now we have this balance turns our tears to joy, our sorrow to peace our inadeqicies into assets. We really can be happy joyous and free if we keep a balance a day at a time in all these there areas.

7-A.

-22-
IX
0166

The two ways of wrking step ten are the spot check. We ask ouse ourselfs if we were for example"asking myself what do I whan t to do today?9(we can make ourselves miserable that way) is my life still ummanagable or have I benntrying to run it? How sincere is my desire to stay claen and sober right this instant.? (if the answer is less that a strong willingness to go to any lenghts then we are in danger of re lapse

Basically we continue to take along hard look at weher we are in relation ship to where we can from. Am I postive? Am I grateful? am I living this way of life? am I free today? am i happyier today thatn before? Do I really want to do Gods will? Do I have consious contact to day? Are my inconvieiencies today going to stop nme from helping that newcomer from having a chance at a new life/? Am I willing to reevaluate myliving habits and change drastica lly if I feel thereatened? Am I striving for progress along spiritual lines? Am I growing? am I a little better today than yesterday or not?

Now that we have acheck list of questions we have an internal measrueingstick . This tells ushow we are doing . If we wish we may share this inventory we may do it daily. Some of us do it once a week. This is good practice .WE find that its ok to share with others . Inadvertantly we are helping them, we are not put of by thoughts of"if share it it will get worse " we should not deny ourselfves this expressing our selves to another human bibeing.

The sex security angd society inventory is is the total over hall. WE take a part our lifes sex , security , society, and spiritual. WE examine our motives for what we have done. For example , we dont merely tell why we got angry we write why the instance made us angery. If we are cheated by an aquaintance we dont merely write "Im made becauce ---- ripped me off" we would write also When he ripped me off I felt that I would never get back what was lost, I felt like it was a big deal, that I worked hard for it and I feel inadiquit to earn the sanme back. Also My esteem is threatened by the fact I was vunerable. I was scared that I would lose much more. I wont have egnough. cause : self centered fear.

Self centered fear is the cause of many of our difficulties. Gratitude-selfless servive may berecomended by th e sponser or person with whom the inventory is shared.

Step 11

That the lie is dead is true. We can not con tinue to live an ungly lie that our happiness lies in out ward things. When we strinve along spiritual lines we are in truth striv- ing toward the highest truth. This truth is God, your God my God ,it makes no difference what his name sake be. Know only that, beyond a shadow of a doubt that he is.

That God Is in every living being is true. Seek not the external luxuries alone for your happiness. Know that the only comfort is God. God alone is real . To srealize this highest truth is not aquired thruogh books. Our minds have strayed and in constant restlessness we addicts tryed speeding them up, slowing them down to get them to rest

7-A.

-23-

This atachment to drugs and alcohol took on a severe from of passionate attachment. We in our ignorace, equivilated ourselves, selves with little more than biological machines, Bodies. Our restless minds were constantly being lured by ignorance , the root of all deasease and death , back in to the obsesion with told us to use drugs.

The truth , enlightenment can not be found in books. It can only be found in the yoga of silent rest with ang on god. With our mind on God It may find rest. However, we will have to drag it fron the passions of this world which c cause its restlessness and disharmony.

We inorder to work step 11 have to for a while at least drag our mind back to the place were we have ckhosen for it back to its seren place or rest with God where it should sta y for the longest possible toime. There , resting between the eye brows it does not wander or squirm restlessly but still and resting in peace it gazes inward to the vision of the God supreme of the meditator. When so we shall engage our mind in sense involvement we shall engage it in ignorance; whence so we engage the ming in the spirit we shall attain knowlege of its will and the power to carry that out. This is the truth : "we sought through prayer and maeditation to imp rove our concious contact with God praying only for the knowleg e of his will for us abnd the power to carry that out. "

When we work we can just work we offer the fruits of o our labor to God , as we may understand him, Remember we all h have our own paths to tread. No man of this world can speak to another of God and be speaking of the only one way . Thier are as many ways to God as thier are human souls and thier is only one way. To engage the mind on REstfiul peace with God rather than to set it on the futile chaces after gratification of the senses. When the senses are gratified we need only realize that it waes not the woman, or man, or the soft cusion, the expesive food , but the God .. the God that felt good. Verily we must at least return to a place ,not in our mind but draggind or leading the mind to a place were ti it can be seren and attentive of God.

"But the mind is shrewd, restless and Self willed and hard to train.? some one says,. " " but by constant practice the mind can be trained in to an awareness of God that surpasses all limitations . The same God you beive in you now can hve an a wareness of that is yours and can not bo taken away from you. REgardless of outside circumstaces,. We can and with the help of a loving God. W can rise above th e level of being a mere biologial robut. This is freedom.

The spiritual principle behind step 11 is awareness of God . Wisdom is the ability to be aware orf Go d in the face of a problem . The 11th steh offers us akeen insight, the ability to have courage, and the ability to feel the pleasure s and pain of others like it is our own. More than anything esle , than exercise, than, worldly weath , than luxuies , step 11 will make us happy.

7-A.

-24-

We may pray for strenght and guidenelce each time we find a disiSion, problem or crisis befalling us. We do not fall into the trap of praying for our way if we do we will get it..... our way almocst killed us. Nay .. we pray for knowlege of our Gods will and for the power cto carry that out... and for that alone do we pray. We may say God ,I would like for this defect to be removed , or , for this pearson to have the best that recovery has to offer the but this is what my whim is only if ti be thy will , My God, let this be done. "Thy will not mine be done always! " would be a good war cry.

Before we engage in any undertaking wether going to a ball ganme or a 12 step call we should first seek to be used as an instrument of Gods will. There is a quiet and soft still voice that will speak to us with in . When it does we should listen and adhere to it .It is obviosly the vioce of God THe supreme speaking and if followed sincerely will lead to wonderful ends. Again our fuction as instruments of his will is to love and serve the Lord and be of selfless service to other hunman beings. This is the real purpose we have as people with something unique to offer the addict seeking help from his addction.

Once someone said that Gods will is an Ideal and that striving for it is an unending journey. Our whole day at a time philosopy is geared not toward the destination but to the journey itself. To keep it simple God's will for us is to "carry this message to the adict who still suffers and to practice these principles in all our affaires after haveing had a spiritual awakening as a result of these steps.

Step 12 has three parts . The 1st is that we were to have a spiritual awakening as a result of having worked the 12 steps of recovery from the disease of addiction to the best of our ability. Part 2 were were to carry this message to addicts and to practice these principles in all our affairs which is the third part.

This graet step is to be proceded by the working of the proceding 11 steps. There are those of us who tryed to work and stay clean off step 12 without 2"having had a spiritual awakenig and as a result are now dead the dope killed them. the ones who continue to "practice these principles in all thier affairs tell us that thids is the most wonerful thing one can know. The journey and the journeys end. A feeling of gratitude. The selfless service that comes from such work is the very principle standing juost behind the surface of step 12. It is indeed the clearness of awareness of Gods grace working through one that provides so much of what the addict out there needs . Just as the grace of a loveing God who we had turned our backs on was brought to us, in hunman form in step 12. So now do we have advance to extend the grace of god to others. Just one 12th step call of this natuer we can make a life time worth while. And thier are plenty of such opportunities for those of us in NA.

Selfless, not selfish, service is the thing that our recovery is based on. WE have been, if we have been working the twelve steps faithfully and to the best of our ability,

7A.

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0466

Fit ourselves into a spiritual state, with the grace of a loving God, to be of maximun and self less service to God and to our f llows. By selfless we mean that with out thought of any thing in return we have Grown to the point to where we can actu-ally care about others. Thier suffering and joys are indeed our own. WE grow to this point through the constant practicing of ... Honesty, hope, faith, courage, Integrity, willingness, humility , brotherly love, disipline, Preserverence ce, awareness of God, and service(selfless).

Some of us were and still may be sicker than others but we need not compare in fact it is selfish and hazardous to our health to do so. WE will grow toward the end of servin g without thought of any thing in return, out of a genuine caring and a genuine intesest in n the recoveries of others.

The 12th step is also very spiritual. It is for for this reason that it is a very important patt of our recovery. "Lord make me an instrument", we may say, as we climb inthe car to help some one. but We dont go it alone. As in all else we dont have to be alone. It is just amatter of finding someone to go with you on this call to carry the message to a suffering addict. We do not set ourselves up as God. We humbly take to the task in love and gratit ude giving what was so freely given to us. We are gratful to have been set free and for the opportunity to help be a real part of God. That is why it is spiritual. We get to become the grace of God in action . It is a privilege and an honor to go out on a 12 step call . The privilege of wanting to serve your NA group.is given to only about 2% of NA. members. Those of us who do service work are the luckiest people on Gods earth. We, who have been in the pits of dispair, now strive to help other people to find a new and better way to live.

pp- begin New paragraph

Our message is that the way of life that we were seeking has been found that we are many on the path and that no one has to go it alone any more if thay want to do it with many wonderful new friends they are unconditonally welcome. Come. The 12 steps work, they have set us free. They have killed our misery causing egos, set us free from fear .They have wrked for us. We now give away the way of life so dear to us.

Glory to God , all glory to God. We never accept credit for making a12 step call#. We only serve as instruments of the one God as we each may understand it differently We pile lavishly all priase we get on that one God as we understand it. God is God. WE are the trusted sevants of God. All Glory to God. All power is the lords! We now care we now would like to help. We no longer wish to partisipate in the problem. We now wish to serve the soloution , which is God as wee understand him . Humbly in this manner do we renew our vow to turn our wills and lives over t o the care of God as we undersytand it. Even if we have no such understa-nding we will aquire it through seeing others recover.

we give it all to God.

They will show that God is loving thy will show his gra ce they will show us more than ewe ever dreamed of knowing the steps do not end here they are just noew beginning.

#7. A. 1

(26)

. Always remember the pain of recovery, sleeplessness mental breakdown, the sickness, the mental obsession, remember your every day that may be all that will keep you from using again.

TPH.

(27)

1. ADDICTION IS NOT A PAST OR LATER.
The sick, self-seeking, self-centered, and self-enclosed world of the addict hardly qualifies as a way of life at best, perhaps it is a way to survive for awhile. Even in this limited existence it is a way of despair, destruction, and death.
Any life style seeking spiritual fulfillment seems to demand the very things missing in addiction: FREEDOM, COUNSEL, CREATIVE ACTION, AND PERSONAL GROWTH.

else where. Many of us had no one else no where else to go ,if wecould not trust our NA group or an individual member who could we trust..

So we asked for help losing our fear.Why when how,did we lose our fear?basically we lost fear by familliarization, We made the move of shareing our living problem with another member. The moere we do this the more we we lose fear because it is not an nunknown . We accustom our selves to seeking help wi th our problems no matter how angry , sascaredv or hpeless we feel and many times we are suprised at how the other person has gone through a similar episode, or is having a related problem. In this way we help each other. ASking for help is a two way street it is help ing the others party more than the himself knows.

I amm glad that I stayed clean long enough for the total message of total abstenence to come through to me. I am also grateful that I was made so welcome at the meetings that I felt comfortable coming to over ninty meetings in ninty days. Without staying totally clean and coming to all those meetings, I would surely have had a rougher time getting with the Twelve Steps. Just one little pill, fix or drink would have interupted the process of recovery and ~~doomed me to repeat the feilures of the past~~. cut me off from you peopl

The most important rule we want to impress upon you in Recovery is Possible but only with a desire, our truest desire & sincerity. When we reach that point where we feel we can't go on, when the thing is overpowering us for us when life's problems get to great & we can't forget with alcohol & drugs. That point we call our Bottom & we want help but don't seem to find it. Confusion. This is when we say we are willing to do any thing to get clean & you must go with this willingness

Dear Dave:

I was into the coffee house scene here in Atlanta. I can remember when the beats wouldn't let me smoke dope or take dexies. Long, long ago!

I don't want to get you mad at me, but what's it like now? See, we aren't just collecting stories for the book. We must have detailed, exact information on just how you and other members worked their steps. There is a growing suspicion that the realities of the steps differ from some of the written material otherwise available to us. Dope fiends talk about God a lot, at least I did. A great part of our mistique is not getting on ego trips. This is where, in recovery, we need courage. We turned our lives and wills over to so many powers greater than ourselves it is hard to see how one more time will help anything. Many of the members here don't come in with anything like a sincere desire to get clean. They get that after the fog has lifted and after they realize that something else is possible. I walked around two years after burning out on chrystal locked up fromthe inside out. I could think of every statement I can make today (sans program, of course) but I just couldn't get it togeather enough to get it out. If I really tried, I would loose track of whatever I was saying in the middle or at the punch line and it would not come back. The first thing in recovery I was grateful for was the clear state of mind. We will use this material as the basis for the basic text portion of our book. The more we investigate, the more we are certain that we'll tufn up some amazing stuff about recovery. That's why we're going to these lengths to encourage members to tell the truth, to the best of their ability and recollection. We have been told that our primary aim should be to tel the truth about our recoveries. Then no matter what, we cannot be controverted. Not only that, I t ink that A great part of my recovery has come when, as I became ready to hear, some member told me the truth. Even if I didn't like it at least I could trust it. Hope I didn't ramble too much. Please write more. I really liked what you sent.

#7A-1

29

Resentments Kill

and energy trying to think of ways to get back at the person. Through our experience we have found that by carrying out our thoughts we hurt ourselves most of all. How many times have we thought, "I'll get you! I'll get loaded!"? In other words, our resentments can only cause harm, and we should rid ourselves of them in any way we can, clean and sober.

WE TRIED TO HELP HIM HELP HIMSELF. WE COULD NOT DO IT FOR HIM. WE TRIED TO HELP HIM GET REAL BY BEING REAL WE TRIED TO RAISE HIS BOTTOM BY BEING LIVING EXAMPLES OF A NEW WAY OF LIFE WITHOUT DRUGS, STREET GAMES, JAILS, INSTITUTIONS AND DEATH.

Trusting our feelings and trusting ou r fellow addicts in recovery are a learnig to live process. It is worth the effoert many people haters s that come here can tell can say that they now see the point in being nice to some one, of showing some compassion for someone other than ourselves. When we found out that we all hurt at times we became awrare that it was ok to hurt and make miastakes clean and sober.WE become trusting of even people with whom we are only mildly aquinted if were sense there sincere desire not to use. A de sire found in the bulk of NA and to be found little

7-A-1

30

RECOVERY IS THE DAILY PRACTICE OF A SPIRITUAL ~~NAME~~ MAINTENANCE PROGRAM, ~~THAT~~ THAT ADDS DIMENSIONS TO ~~AT~~ MY LIFE FROM WHICH I BENEFIT.

RECOVERY DOES NOT TAKE AWAY FROM, ~~RATHER~~ INSTEAD IT ADDS TO IN BECOMING A WORKING PART IN THE WORLD AROUND ME!!

WHEN I CAME TO THE PROGRAM SEEKING HELP, THERE WERE THREE THINGS THAT WERE MORE IMPORTANT THAN ANYTHING ELSE: (1) A WAY TO LIVE & ENJOY LIFE, (2) TO FIND MY PLACE IN THIS WORLD (SOMETHING TOLD ME I WASN'T LIKE EVERYONE ELSE). AND A GOOD WOMAN (NOT NECESSARILY IN THAT ORDER) ALL OF THESE THINGS MEANT ONE ~~THING~~ TO ME, HAPPINESS.

The fine art of expressing a resentment to a person who has offended us begins with our accepting responsibility for taking offense. Sometimes the wisest way to deal with an intolerable person of situation is just to leave it alone. Remember, if we are to learn to deal with difficulties clean, we must stay clean. A threat to our cleanliness is a threat to our lives. We most often resent behavior that we see and fear in ourselves. That is why we can feel so good when we forgive someone who has wronged us. In reality we are forgiving ourselves through forgiving the other person. Is there anything con-

how many of us know someone who has died as a result of using a petty resentment as an ex

#9A-1

knew how I felt! I realized that was what recovery the AA and NA way was all about: the empathy and understanding one addict or alcoholic has for another is the foundation for recovery. I replied to this man that I was indeed hurting and

A-A Billions can be spent and not do half the good of a kn knowing smile and the warm feeling we get from our meetings and our fellowship. Much progress has be n made in working with institutions where addicts detoxify from drugs. Their's is a vital role in insuring the physical health of a person with severe addiction problems. We respect their approach and appreciate their efforts. Many lives are saved. Our program is directed toward staying clean.

Long-time addicts must patiently relearn the things forgotten and learn what they have missed.

> For some strange reason I got into my thick skull that somehow alcohol and drugs could provide the hidden clue to the mystery of life. I pursued this belief with ferocious tenacity until I realized that not only were drugs and alcohol not providing me with clues as to the secret of life they were rapidly robbing me of my life.

Gone are the chemical mood changers. With help we can learn to take our reality clean. We should remember that we are powerless

In recovery it is perfectally all right for us to feel our emotions. We will not flip out or make our fellow NAs mad at us. We are on coc rar. facing our selfs maore sqarely facet by facet. We eventually learn that our heads lie to us that we cannot trust them that our emotions can be trusted.Addiction has been termed a feeling disease.

Long-time addicts must patiently relearn the things forgotten and learn what they have missed. For instance many of our people have never learned to work. They started dope to young or just bummed around.

#7 A, 2

(32)

Most programs people visit now. Maintenance programs will not work for us because we have to stop using all together. Sometimes it is necessary to methadone slowly but at some point we must stop taking drugs. Some of us have used methadone programs to help us solve our problem but we always ended up keeping drugs in our blood to prevent withdrawal pains, but usually we ended up sicker than before.

7A2

As a newcomer to Narcotics Anonymous, I believe this is what NA is all about. It's about people who can care about and love a desperate, dying addict. And who can, in time, teach him how to care and ~~x~~ love also. It's BEAUTIFUL!

The body is an ocean of life over 1000000 miles long end to end . Drugs of various types pollute this ocean and we being after all creatures of adaptation, we adapt to the polluted environment ,addicts to the degree that return to normal life becomes impossible . the abstemence we may abtain stability and overcome the physical symptoms of addiction. ,our thinking gradually clers up. Any exposure to the polluting drugs reactivates the addiction and the symptoms. 7-4

There is something theraputive for the drug addict in talking about answers. WE can ask for help, but the fellowship responds with answers. Connie B. We seek solutions rather than dilemmas. We try always to seek answers for our suffering addicts.
Productive means being clean and sober ,dreative and loving today. Mary Ann You can find your own meaning for productive , responsible , and productive member of society. Olaf

Without our Higher Power we cannot do anything for you. Only limited attempts will only lead us back to using & possibly death. Only limited attempt will work for short periods of time and will begin to feel good and allow ourselves to think we can handle drugs now, but we fail with that. many of us have been there, most already and the result was the same we ended up sicker than before some of us ended up dead

7B

#7 - 4, 2

(33)

as if the person is eaten away from the inside. This can be over-emphasized and can be used as a crutch to avoid recovery, but it's also true. A friend in the program and I discussed what a person would be like if they slept all day, did not work, didm not talk to anyone, did not think or read-- in short did nothing all day long. Well wouldn't they forget social graces, aquire weird habits and mannerisms, forget how to work, forget how to express themselves and show concern for others, forget how to feel...

Long-time addicts must patiently relearn the things forgotten and learn what they have missed. For instance many of our people have never learned to work. They started dope to young or just bummed around. Other...

structive I can do to change my situation, or should I leave it alone?

The story is told of the man who had been buying a newspaper at the same stand for years. The man in charge of the stand was always surly and rude, but the man bought the paper and wished the fellow a good day. Amazed, someone commented, "How can you be so friendly with such a sour person?" "Because", said the man, "I just couldn't let someone else have the power to determine my reaction."

Realizing our resentments can be fatal, we should take them seriously and learn to use the tools of the program to overcome them.

(Not only do they change with respect to the problems which brought them into the group; they also, for example, often stop smoking and make alterations in other areas of their lives which they originally did not know they could change. Smoking, drinking, and pill-taking are rendered considerably less attractive when we deal with the guilt in our lives in other, more basic ways.)

#7. A. 2

(34)

In answer to prayer, some 3½ months ago, two persons from the Atlanta NA group came to an AA meeting (of all places in the way out area of Bryson City, N.C.). I shall always be indebted to both these NA people, for they began to make me face total sanity - total sobriety within NA fellowship. Incidentally, I recognize that perhaps one reason I am so way out was my efforts to escape drugs. It's been partly helpful, but for an addict, we all know there is no place perhaps on this entire green earth we can escape - as long as the desire is active. But turn this around and

you may conceive why I (with God's help and NA support in whatever capacity) must make a success of the program in a way out capacity.

HE WANTED TO BE ACCEPTED, TO BE ACCEPTED AND LOVED. AND HE WAS, HE WAS ACCEPTED AND LOVED IN THE FELLOWSHIP OF NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS. AS A NEWCOMER WE ALL KNEW HIM; SOME OF US TRAVELED THE SAME DESPERATE ROAD OF LONLINESS AND LACK OF RECOGNITION, LACK OF HOPE. WE UNDERSTOOD WHEN HE TALKE ABOUT DRUGS AND THE VAST QUANITIES HE CONSUMED.

Most addicts are able to accept this type of sharing even in the beginning. In time we have a new source of strength that will that will help give us the guidance we need to effect our own recoveries. The group we choose to be our home group will be like a spiritual savings account. The more we can invest in it through our caring and sharing, the greater the dividends it will pay.

#7 A.2

35

In overcoming our self-centeredness, we first learn to reach out. When is not too important though the relief we have felt forces us to be honest and say the sooner the better. Reaching out to others generally comes as a natural result of being in a group of fellow recovering addicts who encourage us to share by their example. The principle that pain shared is pain lessened and joy shared is joy increased applys here. Having taken this step, many of us find moments of confusion and dispair which make us want to run and hide. We are free to do this if we have to, but as we grow in our recoveries we can learn to get out of ourselves and find fellow members who are ever ready to help us with difficulties as they arise if we can only remember to ask.

All of us who find the program and at least begin to work the steps develop some kmid of relationship with others. As we grow we learn to overcome our tendancy to run and hide our real feelings. Learning to be totally honest about our feelings helps other people take us seriously and we find that when we come across honestly it seems to reach others better. Honesty takes practice and none of us profess to be perfect in thsi area. Whenever we feel trapped or pressured, it takes great spiritual and emotional strength to be honest. Sharing our lives with others seems to keep us from feeling trapped or pressured as often. The steps lead to the kind of honesty that can help us let others know us and accept others.

Mostly, I think, addiction is a statement of how the addict feels about himself and the world. For the addict to want to make another statement he must reach a point of pain at a time when the program or some form of higher power is a t hand. For tha addict to suceed in making another statemant it is useful to spend a great deal of time with persons who hav e been there. These people usually take great pleasure in helping a suffering addict recover and have great insight and many useful suggestions to offer when asked. Recovery as is found in Narcotics Anonymous must come from within and no one can get clean for anyone else.

#7 A.3

(36)

*** "SLIPPING BY THE THIRD STEP" *** by John S 0107

This past week I took the opportunity to avoid several of my responsibilities. was able to justify missing meetings, skipping work, neglecting twelfth--step ork, and most important, I stopped asking for help. I have not felt so far out f whack since I've been sober. I could sense a change coming over me. My abil-ty to remain slightly open-minded was gone. I became angry and resentful to-ard anyone and everyone. I began to torment those who are close to me. I be-ame genuinely sick with myself in a few days.

I feel as though I could sense a fraction of what I would become if I was gain to use. For surely, missing meetings is a step back. I have to admit, I ive credit to those addicts who can stay away from N.A. for any length of time. f they can live with themselves in that frame of mind, God bless them! Today I know I can't.

Above all else the Addict must stay working steps as most important. Without this Addict, and it can only be formulated after attending several meetings, I assume is a waste of time you might as well be using and getting sick and suicidal so that you will have the Addict or dead. There are no other choices for us. Try one way for a while we suggest that you go to — meetings in — days and then make up your mind. If you go back using we must give the test. If you decide you won't what all

7-A-4

(37)

As a kisease, drug addiction is subject to relapses. REverting to drug use is physical relapse. Physical relapse is only a symptom.

In our daily lives we are subject to emotional and spiritual relapses, causing us to become defenseless against the physical relapse of drug use.

We are never forced into relapse, we are driven to choice. Relapse is rarely an accident. Our knowledge of drug addiction is not enough to stop us from using.

Relapse is a sign we have had reservations in our programs. We slighted our programs and left loopholes in our daily lives. Aware of the pitfalls ahead, we trod blindly on in the belief we could make it on our own. Sooner or later we fell back into the illusion that drugs would make life easier. We believed that drugs would change us, and we forgot that the changes are lethal.

Getting loaded is not as bad as living through it.
As I uncover things about me I will discover t ings about me . As I discover things about me I will discard . Marion B.

7A 4

Slow down and live life.
A Cynic is someone who has been very dissapointed. James H.
The head does not hear until the heart decides to listen . Bi ll W
My feet are firmly planted on the ground and you cant let me down
Praise in public ,criticize in private.
Its not shameful to slip The real shame is not coming back.
Recieving Help Phamplet-Acceptance -Being Gracious -Clearly expressing need to those able to help. Overcoming fear of people . Comftorable vulnerability. Practicing open mindednesss . Willing to try new t ings.

[illegible] been acquainted [illegible] disease. Many of ournew-comershave the dif iculty of coming into the fellowship in areas not accustomed to presenting the disease concept . We are doomed to seee our past behavior as part of our ~~disease~~ selves and not part of our disease. As long as we preserve our ~~disease~~cleanliness we enjoy the greatest possible advantage over our disease. For this we can be grateful. The first thing to do is get clean and sober . This will clean our bodies and free our minds. This will make the other stages Of recovery possible. Learn about the disease conception of addiction. Try to ignore immediate past behavior. and realize it was caused by our addiction.,our disease and the use of drugs in one fom or another. Go to meetings and study the program for your ownpersonal growth.
Obcession The got to's got me D avid.

#7. A-4 relapse & return (38)

I am so acutely aware of the dangers faced by such as ourselves in these days of fast moving medicine, and all of this as a result of my recovery through NA.

After a slip — then what? It's so hard to straighten up again.

There are two experiences which I wanted to pass along for the benefit of other addicts having to do with medical emergencies, the physician administration of clinically indicated drugs, and the recovering drug addict. The first one occurred 3 years after. You see, after the first dose of painkiller, I was no longer seeking relief from physical pain, but was seeking that "oblivion" which was the unnatural habitat of my life for so many years before. My disease had been reactivated by the simple introduction of a "legitimate" drug into my system, and I once again slipped into the addict mentality, with all of the obsessions, rationalizations, and insanity.

The obcessiveness is really common to all the addicts ve met or heard of... Like a guy will get a scene or a rap going hat will be like his cloak when his life is used up. The things e talks about when he has no real life left. Obcessions drive ddicts past the normal human limits and many times wins them reat fame of recognition-- until they burn out. The drug induced tates can allow a person to exclude all the normal background wareness and focus entirely on a single point. At first this an be like a handy magnifying glass used at will. Later it ca n ecome a horrible sequence of all-consuming bits and pieces that ush up continually and we find ourselves powerless to control nat's happening to us. Speed is definitely obcessive. Downs can elieve some of the pains of obcessions and become the ultimate bcession. Obcessions are like mental spasms. The mind ~~xunxinta~~ m draws up like a spastic muscle. It shorts out and ceases to function normally. The subconcious mind is free to act.

#7

B.

(39)

The obcessiveness is really common to all the addicts I've met or heard of... Like a guy will get a scene or a rap going that will be like his cloak when his life is used up. The things he talks about when he has no real life left. Obcessions drive addicts past the normal human limits and many times wins them great fame of recognition-- until they burn out. The drug induced states can allow a person to exclude all the normal background awareness and focus entirely on a single point. At first this can be like a handy magnifying glass used at will. Later it can become a horrible sequence of all-consuming bits and pieces that rush up continually and we find ourselves powerless to control what's happening to us. Speed is definitely obcessive. Downs can relieve some of the pains of obcessions and become the ultimate obcession. Obcessions are like mental spasms. The mind draws up like a spastic muscle. It shorts out and ceases to function normally. The subconcious mind is free to act.

#1 B

(40)

Being able to reach out to others when we need help and responding to others in need is a major part of the recovery we seek in N.A. The flow that is life takes place in this manner. We come here in powerless and needing manageability and the power we seek comes to us through other people in the program if can only reach out for it. New to the program of years clean we will want to keep ourselves surrou nded by fellow members that we have let know us well and who we .eel we can count on in a pinch. N.A. is a fellowship of survival and one of the advantages of the program is that it places us in intimate regular contact with the very people who can most understand and help us in ourquest for sobriety. All the godd ideas and intentions will help us not at all if we fail to put them into action. Reaching out is the beginning of the struggle that will make us free. It will break down the walls that have kept us prisioner so long. The walls that havekept us in and those who would have h helpedus out. Maybe there was a time when the defence mechanisms actually helped us survive but who needs a rain coat when the sun has co.e out? Trouble is many of them have become embedded in our nature and have becom. invisible to us.

Reality became so painful that oblivion beaame plaasure. Aperson living in that state of mind cannot be expected to react normally to life. One essence of addiction is that the addict when confronted with unpleasant reality has learned to change the perception instead of the reality.

#0032 (41)

Clean & sober, the most I had ever had. Yet the feeling returned and I picks up a joint, few days later I took a red within a week I was shooting dope again. This started a period where I used for 10 months day & nite. Drinking, shooting dope & taking pills, I get to a point where I new I would never get ~~to~~ clean again, I had completly surrendered to drugs. My wife left me. We had two children, our little girl was 3 and we had a little boy almost two. For some unknown reason she left our little ~~boy~~ boy with me. Today I know that was God also, for the next 3 or 4 months he is probably what kept me alive. I identifies with the mother who uses & yet tries to raise children at the same time. For I found myself in many blackouts not even knowing how my son was. Yet knowing he was there must of kept me somewhat aware of living.

On the morning of Oct 20, 1971 I woke up, there was dope in the house, for some reason I didn't get loaded right then. I took my son and went across the street to the beach. It was a gray morning. I remember ~~it~~ sitting on the beach, crying, just wanting to die. I just couldn't go on. A feeling went threw me that I had never experienced befor, it was like someone put a blanket around me. I felt warm & peaceful within, a voice within said, its over you don't have to use again, I felt peace then I had ever felt in my life. I pick up my son went home and pack my suit case. ~~I had~~ One of my sober friends had moved to another Island, I flew over & found him. When I walk in the door I told him I was ready to do anything to stay clean. Has I sit here and write this its Oct 19, tomorrow I will have 8 years clean & sober and thats a miracle, I am still willing to do anything to stay clean & sober.

#7 B

(42)

SYMPTOMS LEADING TO RELAPSE

1) Exhaustion
2) Dishonesty
3) Impatience
4) Argumentativeness
5) Depression
6) Frustration
7) Self-pity
8) Cockiness
9) Complacency
10) Expecting too much from others
11) Letting up on disciplines
12) Use of mood-altering chemicals
13) Wanting too much
14) Forgetting gratitude
15) Rigid judgemental outlook
16) Tense impatience
17) Easily bored
18) Easily distracted
19) Rationalization
20) General immature attitudes and behavior of the old way of thinking.

. AA is a closed set of alcoholics helping one another. and cannot include nonalcoholics. NA is an open set which can include anyone with any addiction problem. Further discussion will probably help clarify the situation and help us know what were about. Bo S.

Since self-centeredness is at the root of all our defects of character,
our abi[illegible]

#7-B Stumbling Blocks (43)

7-B ~~Horribly~~ anyone convicted of a crime has had ~~no~~ experience with drugs. Many have actually been under the immediate or residual effects of addiction at the time they committed their crime. We believe there is a connection. Obviously many drug dealers and users wind up behind bars. It is barely possible that ~~crimes~~ CRIMES and antisocial behaviour are as much a symptom of addiction as drunk driving is to the alcoholic. The drug induced states are many times ~~xxxx~~ more disabling than alcohol and ~~xx~~ the same time more easily concealed. True crime involves volition and we believe that persons with our disease cannot be considered entirely responsible for their actions. It is not our purpose to create confusion and say that criminals should not be prosecuted but ~~xxxx~~ only that addiction needs to be recognized as a disease and those suffering from addiction ~~xxxx~~ have an opportunity to recover.

Then in my"infinite knowlege of all things"
I decided I didnt need to attend meeting any more. I s
still didnt understand the Na program and I was too
lazy to put forth the effort nessary to begin to
understand.

#7 - B Stumbling Blocks (44)

People who do not take a personal inventory immediately after they turn their will and lives over to God, tend to develop the "Relapse Waltz:" "Step 1,2,3; 1,2,3,; 1,2,3.

For some three months in AA I continued to play games. I told God I'd give up ETOH, but please let me retain at least marijuana. Isn't it a fact everyone needs something?? And then, too, even though I truly now love my entire AA group here (and I've learned and grown perhaps in the last six months more than in my entire life); I could not discuss my dual addiction. In this program and area, I truly believe ETOH was their only addiction. But down deep, I knew I was being only 50% honest. The name (and word) of the program is total "sobriety".

I knew because I cared, but cared too much to say no. This was my pattern of seeking out friends, relationships that I could feed off of for drugs always scared of not getting enough. My greatest fear was getting cut off or busted and incarcerated again.

(A resentment is a bad feeling that you have to live with until you figure out what to do with it...)

TODAY I SEE EVERYTHING I DID TO "ENJOY" LIFE WAS FOR ONE PURPOSE, TO FILL A VOID DEEP INSIDE THAT COULDN'T BE FILLED. (OR SO IT SEEMED) AND THOUGH I WAS POWERLESS & UNMANAGABLE, I COULDN'T SEE IT.

So my using was miserable. I wanted to die. I went to church, I stayed at a monastery and ended up stealing from them, raiding their medicine cabinet and stealing valium and drinking the sacrificial wine. I was asked to leave and it seemed the more I made attempts to stay clean the more I fell.